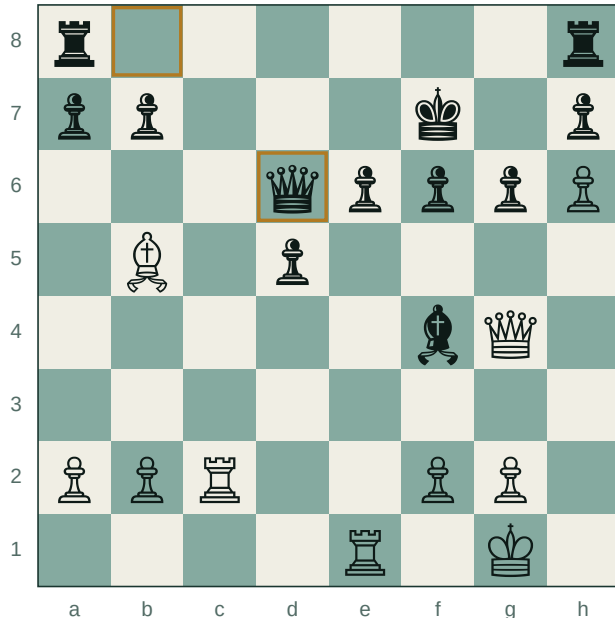


Deflection tactics: White, move 23

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 22...Qd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Rc7+ Qxc7 24. Qxe6+ Kf8 25. Qxf6+

23.Rc7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **23...Qxc7**.

24.Qxe6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on e6. Recorded reply: **24...Kf8**.

25.Qxf6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on f8, rook on h8 and bishop on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -3: the balance goes from -2 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.